



Taste the Past

MAKE • COOK • ENJOY

Early Alabamians were often self-sufficient and made many of their own foods at home. Choose one of the activities below to experience a traditional frontier food.

Option 1: Make Butter in a Jar

Settlers often made their own butter from fresh cream. You can make butter too using just a jar and a few simple ingredients!

You Will Need:

- 1 cup heavy whipping cream
- A clean jar with a lid
- A pinch of salt (optional)



Directions:

1. Pour the cream into the jar and tighten the lid.
2. Shake the jar hard for 5–10 minutes.
3. Watch as the cream turns into butter!
4. Pour off the liquid (buttermilk).
5. Add a pinch of salt if you like.
6. Enjoy your homemade butter on bread, crackers, or cornbread!

What's Happening?

As you shake, the fat in the cream clumps together to make butter. This is the same process settlers used, but they often used a butter churn instead of a jar!



"Simple foods often bring the greatest joy."

Option 2: Bake Cornbread Together

Cornbread was a common and important food for many Alabamians. It was simple, filling, and made from ingredients they grew.

You Will Need:

- 1 cup yellow cornmeal
- 1 cup all-purpose flour
- 1 tablespoon sugar (optional)
- 1 tablespoon baking powder
- 1/2 teaspoon salt
- 1 cup milk
- 1 egg
- 1/4 cup melted butter or oil



Directions:

1. Preheat oven to 400°F.
2. In a large bowl, mix cornmeal, flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt.
3. In another bowl, mix milk, egg, and melted butter.
4. Combine wet and dry ingredients and stir until just mixed.
5. Pour into a greased cast-iron skillet or baking dish.
6. Bake for 20–25 minutes, or until golden brown.
7. Let it cool a bit, then enjoy!



Fun Fact:

Corn was an important crop in Alabama and was used to make many foods, including cornbread, mush, and tortillas.

Good food brings people together.